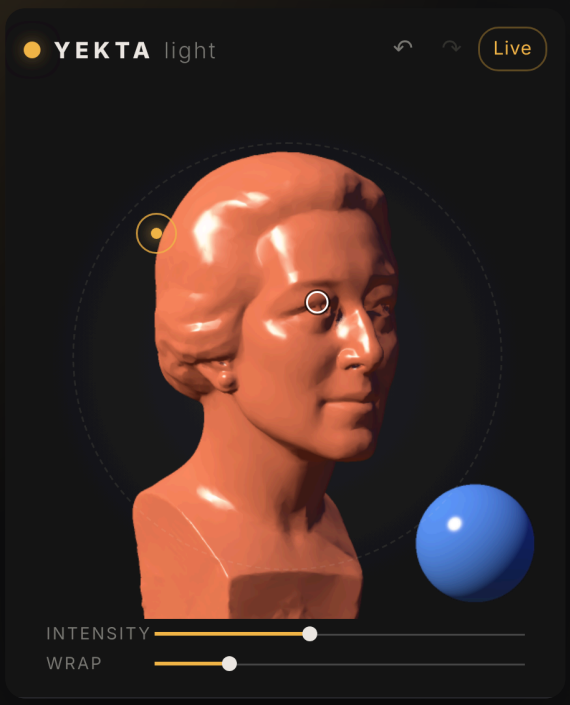
YEKTA light




USER GUIDE

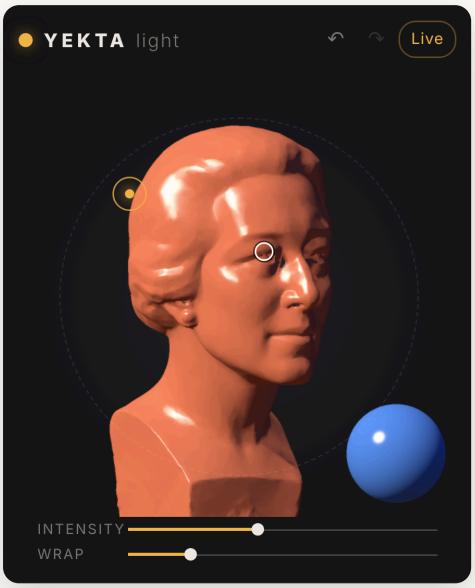
# Every option, explained.

Light a 3D form, then pick the color the light really makes — highlight, halftone, core shadow, reflected light. This guide walks through every control of Yekta Light.

01 · THE IDEA

# How Yekta Light works

Instead of guessing what a color does in light and shadow, you place a real light on a real 3D form and read the result. Every color you pick is physically lit.




The fixed top area

## Layout

The panel has two parts. The **top** — logo, 3D view and two quick sliders — never scrolls, so you always see the result. Everything **below** scrolls: tools, palettes and settings. Change any option and watch the form update live.

## A typical workflow

1. Choose a form (a head, the skull, a sphere...).
2. Light it — drag the sun or pick a portrait setup.
3. Check the shapes in **Notan** and the values in **3 / 5**.
4. Switch to **Color** and set your local color (Base).
5. Pick colors from the form or from the **Light Families**, and paint.

02 · HEADER

# Top bar

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| ↶ ↷ **Undo / Redo** | Steps back and forward through your changes to the look (light, materials, colors, camera). Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Shift+Z. |
| **Live** | On: the color is sent to Photoshop (or copied in the desktop app) continuously while you drag on the form. Off: only when you release. |
| **Pin (desktop app)** | Keeps the Yekta Light window on top of Clip Studio Paint. |

03 · THE 3D VIEW

# Picking and lighting



Color



Notan

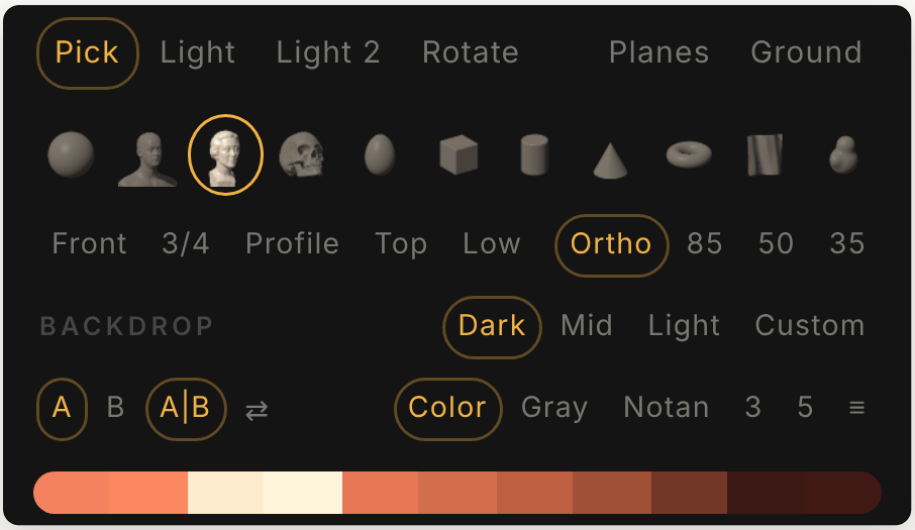


5 values

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Click / drag on the form** | Picks the lit color under the cursor. A ring marks the spot. |
| **Sun handle (amber)** | The key light. Drag it anywhere. Inside the dashed ring the light is in front of the form; outside the ring it moves behind it (back light / rim). |
| **Light 2 handle (blue)** | The second light. Appears when Light 2 is on; drag it like the sun. |
| **Alt + drag** | Moves the key light without switching modes. |
| **Shift + drag** | Rotates the form without switching modes. |
| **Small sphere (B)** | Shows material B next to the main form for comparison (toggle A\|B). |
| **Intensity** | Brightness of the key light. Double-click to reset. |
| **Wrap** | How far the light wraps around the form. Low = hard terminator (plaster, metal); high = soft, glowing transition (skin, fabric). |

04 · TOOLS ROW

# Modes, forms, camera, backdrop




| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Pick · Light · Light 2 · Rotate** | What dragging on the 3D view does. Shortcuts: P, L, R. |
| **Planes** | Faceted block-in mode: the form is shown as flat planes, like a planes-of-the-head study. |
| **Ground** | Adds a ground plane with a cast shadow and contact shadow. You can pick the shadow color off the ground. |
| **Forms** | Sphere · male head scan · female head scan · skull · **posable full bodies** (female, male, female mannequin, male mannequin) · egg · cube · cylinder · cone · torus · drapery · organic form. |
| **Front · 3/4 · Profile · Top · Low** | Camera angles for the forms. |
| **Ortho · 85 · 50 · 35** | Lens. Ortho has no perspective; 35 mm gives strong perspective (close-up portrait look). |
| **Backdrop** | Background behind the form: Dark, Mid gray, Light or Custom (set its color in 03 Color ▸ Backdrop). Judge values against your canvas tone. |
| **A · B · A\|B · ⇄** | Choose which material you edit (A = main form, B = small sphere), show/hide the B sphere, swap A and B. |
| **Color · Gray · Notan · 3 · 5** | Value modes. Gray = grayscale; Notan = two values (light / shadow); 3 and 5 = grouped values. Shortcut: V cycles them. |
| ≡ | Highlights every area that has the same value as the picked color — great for checking value groups. |
| **Value ramp** | The strip under the toolbar: every value across the form, from light to core shadow. Click to pick. |

04B · POSE

# Posable full bodies

Four full bodies are fully rigged — female and male (realistic) and two mannequins. Pick one and the **Pose** box appears under the forms. Every joint, including all fingers, can be posed.



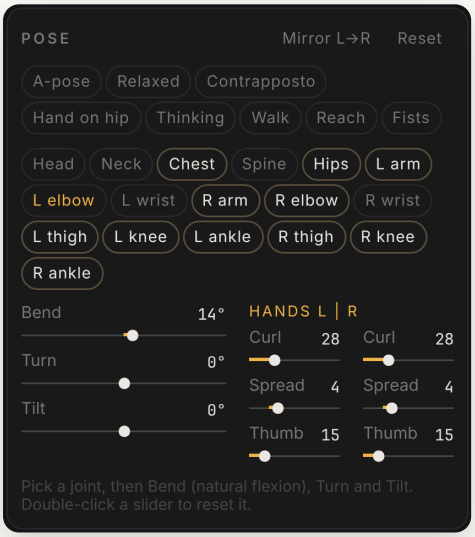
Contrapposto



Hand on hip



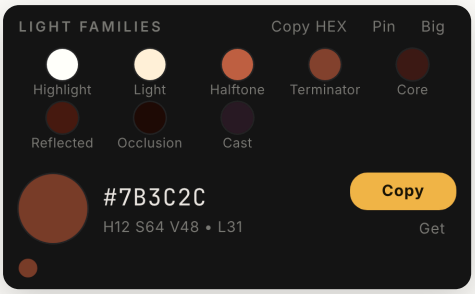
Walk




| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Presets** | A-pose, Relaxed, Contrapposto, Hand on hip, Thinking, Walk, Reach, Fists — one click, then adjust. |
| **Joint chips** | Head, neck, chest, spine, hips, arms, elbows, wrists, thighs, knees, ankles. Chips of joints you changed are highlighted. |
| **Bend** | Natural flexion of the selected joint: elbows and knees bend, arms and legs swing forward, the head nods. |
| **Turn** | Rotation around the vertical axis (look left / right, twist the torso). |
| **Tilt** | Sideways: on arms it raises them out to the side, on the head and torso it leans. |
| **Hands L \| R** | **Curl** closes all fingers into a fist, **Spread** fans them, **Thumb** folds the thumb. |
| **Mirror L→R** | Copies the left side of the pose to the right. |
| **Reset** | Back to the A-pose. Double-click any slider to reset only that value. |

05 · LIGHT FAMILIES & PICK BAR

# Named colors, ready to paint

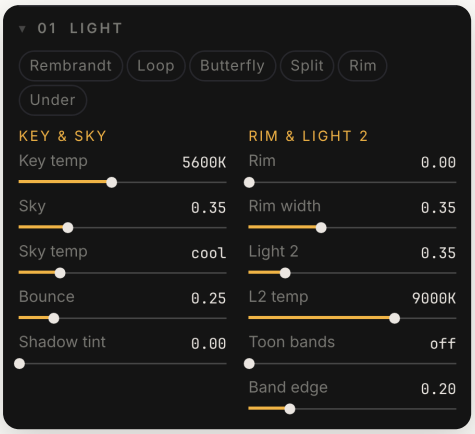



| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Highlight** | The specular hot spot. |
| **Light** | Fully lit local color. |
| **Halftone** | Turning away from the light. |
| **Terminator** | Where light meets shadow — often the most saturated. |
| **Core** | Darkest part of the form shadow. |
| **Rim** | Edge light (appears when Rim is on). |
| **Reflected** | Bounce light inside the shadow. |
| **Occlusion** | Deepest contact darks. |
| **Cast** | Cast shadow color. |

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **+ Swatches / Copy HEX** | Photoshop: adds all family colors to the Swatches panel. Desktop: copies them as a HEX list. |
| **Pin** | Pin mode: click a family color to lock it (amber dot) so it no longer changes with the light. Click again to unpin. Alt-click also pins. |
| **Big** | Large swatches — ideal for the Clip Studio screen eyedropper. |
| **Big swatch + HEX** | The picked color. Type a HEX code to set it directly. |
| **H S V • L** | Hue, saturation, value and perceived lightness (L) of the picked color. |
| **Low chroma warning · Fix** | Shown when a pick is much grayer than your base color (likely to read muddy). Fix restores color while keeping value and hue. |
| **Set FG / Copy** | Photoshop: sets the foreground color. Desktop: copies the HEX. |
| **BG (Photoshop)** | Sets the background color. |
| **Get** | Loads Photoshop's foreground (or a HEX from the clipboard) into the selected color target. |
| **Follow FG (Photoshop)** | When the Photoshop foreground changes, it becomes the base color of the form — preview any color under your light. |
| **History dots** | Your recent picks. Click to reuse. |

06 · 01 LIGHT

# Shape the light

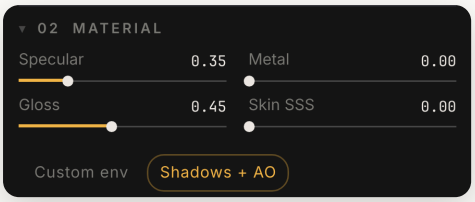



| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Rembrandt** | Key 45° to the side and above — the classic triangle of light on the shadow cheek. |
| **Loop** | Softer side angle; small nose shadow loops toward the cheek. |
| **Butterfly** | Light from the front and above — symmetrical, glamour look. |
| **Split** | Light from the side — half the face in shadow. |
| **Rim** | Light from behind plus a soft front fill — glowing edges. |
| **Under** | Light from below — dramatic / horror. |

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Key temp** | Color temperature of the key light in Kelvin: 2000 K candle-orange to 10000 K blue sky. 5600 K is daylight. |
| **Sky** | Strength of the ambient light from above (fills the shadows). |
| **Sky temp** | Cool to warm color of that ambient light. |
| **Bounce** | Light reflected up from the ground into the shadows (reflected light). Its color is set in 03 Color ▸ Bounce. |
| **Shadow tint** | Pushes the hue of the shadow areas toward a chosen color (03 Color ▸ Shadow) while keeping their value. |
| **Rim · Rim width** | Fresnel edge light and how wide it spreads. |
| **Light 2** | Strength of the second light (fill or kicker). Above 0 turns it on. |
| **L2 temp** | Kelvin temperature of the second light. |
| **Toon bands · Band edge** | Cel shading: splits the light into 2–6 flat bands; Band edge softens the transitions. |

07 · 02 MATERIAL

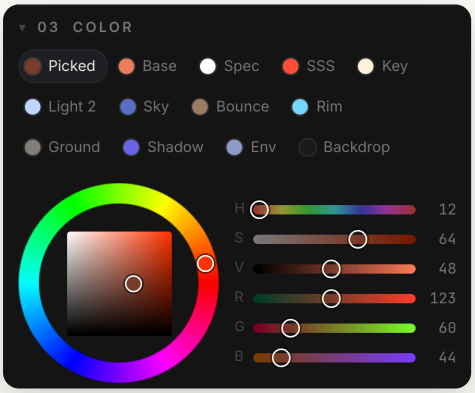
# What the form is made of




| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Specular** | Strength of the highlight. |
| **Gloss** | Size of the highlight: low = broad and soft (skin, clay), high = tiny and sharp (plastic, metal). |
| **Metal** | Metallic look: the highlight takes the base color and the environment is reflected. |
| **Skin SSS** | Subsurface scattering: a warm, saturated glow along the terminator, like light passing through skin. Its color is 03 Color ▸ SSS. |
| **Custom env** | Uses your own environment color (03 Color ▸ Env) for reflections on metal and gloss instead of the sky color. |
| **Shadows + AO** | Self-shadowing and ambient occlusion on the heads, skull, torus and drapery. |

08 · 03 COLOR

# Total color control

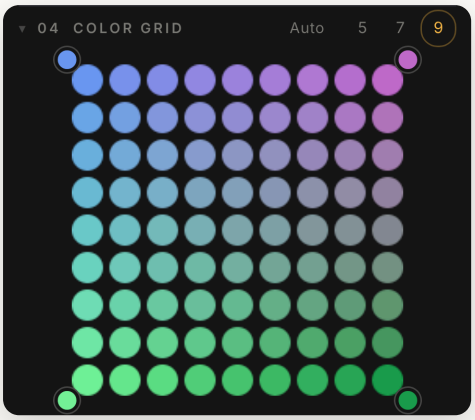



Choose a **target chip**, then edit it with the wheel (hue ring + saturation/value square) or the H S V R G B sliders. The form updates live.

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Picked** | The color you send to your app. |
| **Base** | Local color of the material. |
| **Spec** | Highlight color. |
| **SSS** | Subsurface glow color. |
| **Key · Light 2** | Light colors. |
| **Sky · Bounce** | Ambient light above / reflected light below. |
| **Rim** | Edge light color. |
| **Ground** | Ground plane color. |
| **Shadow** | Shadow tint color. |
| **Env** | Environment reflection color. |
| **Backdrop** | Custom background behind the form. |

09 · 04 COLOR GRID

## Harmonies between four colors




| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Corners** | Click a corner dot to make it the color target, then edit it with the wheel. |
| **Grid** | Every step between the four corners, blended in OKLab (perceptually even). Click a dot to pick it. |
| **Auto** | Fills the corners from your current light families. |
| **5 · 7 · 9** | Grid density. |

10 · 05 PRESETS

## Looks in one click




Warm skin, Deep skin, Gold, Chrome, Glossy plastic, Matte clay, Plaster cast, Anime cel, Neon rim night, Sunset, Overcast, Campfire.

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **Click** | Applies the light and the material. |
| **Shift-click** | Material only. |
| **Alt-click** | Light only. |
| **+ Save** | Saves your current light and material as a new preset (× deletes it). |

11 · SHORTCUTS & PERFORMANCE

## Good to know

| CONTROL | WHAT IT DOES |
|---|---|
| **P · L · R** | Pick / Light / Rotate mode. |
| **V** | Cycle value modes. |
| **Ctrl+Z · Ctrl+Shift+Z** | Undo · Redo (Cmd on macOS). |
| **Double-click a slider** | Reset it to default. |
| **Performance** | Rendering runs in short slices, so Photoshop and Clip Studio stay responsive. While you drag you see a fast preview; the sharp frame follows when you stop. Nothing runs while you are not using the panel. |

3D models: male head “Lee Perry-Smith” scan © Infinite-Realities, CC BY 3.0 · female head “Woman’s Head” by Artur Loewental, scan by Three D Scans · skull by Vladimir Petkovic, Khronos glTF samples, CC0 · full bodies: Grab3D Man / Woman Base Mesh (CC0) and Quaternius Universal Base Characters (CC0); finger rig on the Grab3D bodies added by Yekta Light. Yekta Light is free — yektapour.com